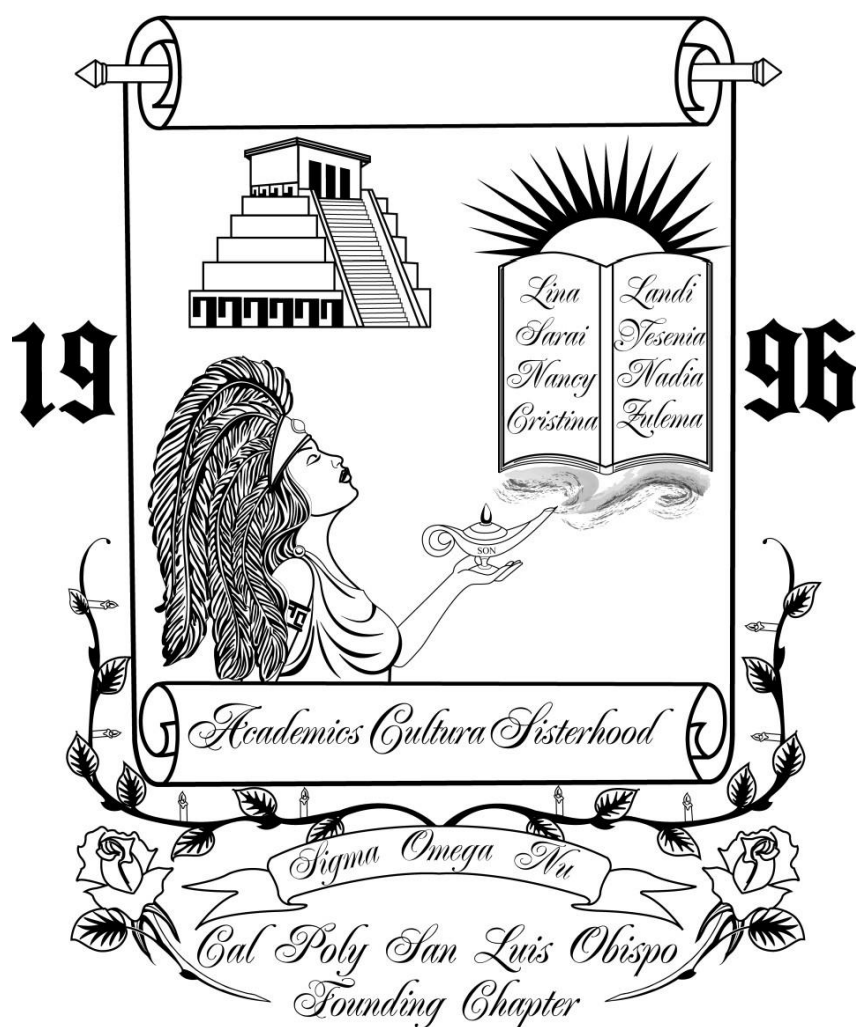


ΣΩΝ

Sigma Omega Nu

Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



Chapter Standing Rules

Chapter Standing Rules

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Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. Chapter Standing Rules

Article I. Meetings

Section A. Meeting Order

All meetings shall follow the following format.

1. Call to Order – President
2. Founders' Chant – All Members
3. Roll Call & Quorum – Sergeant at Arms
4. Review and Approval of Last Meeting's Minutes
5. Review and Approval of Current Meeting's Agenda
6. Action Items
7. Officer Reports
8. New Business
9. Old Business
10. Announcements
11. Adjournment – President

The President shall oversee the general running of the meeting, and the Sergeant at Arms shall keep order.

Section B. Founders' Chant

“Academics, cultura, and sisterhood are the things we hold true and we shall remain faithful to the letter of Sigma Omega Nu. The sun, a symbol of our existence. White and yellow roses, the sign of pure friendship. Black, burgundy, and gold, the colors we represent which tell our story. For all the struggles we may face, together we will live, learn, and celebrate that which unites us as hermanas.”

Section C. Robert's Rules of Order

Meetings shall follow Robert's Rules of Order, as specified in Article IX, Section F of the Chapter Bylaws. A basic outline of Robert's Rules of Order is below.

1. Agenda
 - a. All meetings shall follow a fixed agenda as listed in Section A above.
 - b. If anyone wants to discuss anything not already on the agenda, they must request it be added to the agenda before it is approved.
2. Motions [a proposal to take a stand on an issue]
 - a. The proposal cannot contradict the National Bylaws, Chapter Bylaws, Standing Rules or University regulations

- b. The motion must be specific to the issue that it deals with.
 - c. The motion must be in the form: "I motion to"
- 3. Second to the Motion
 - a. A second to the motion is needed by another member
 - b. If there is no second the motion dies
 - c. There is no discussion until there is a second to the motion
- 4. Discussion
 - a. Discussion is open to all Active Members.
 - b. Discussion from Inactive Members or Alumni may only be voiced if Active Membership agrees
 - c. The member who made the original motion shall explain her motion, show evidence to support, explain why this would work best, etc.
 - d. Other members may ask questions or comment about the motion
 - e. Other members may suggest amendments to the current motion.
 - f. The Sergeant at Arms shall limit the amount of time spent on discussion and can end it when she sees fit.
- 5. Re-state Motion
 - a. Once discussion is closed by the Sergeant at Arms, the original motioner must restate the motion.
 - b. The original motioner shall decide whether or not to incorporate suggested amendments made during the discussion. If so, the re-state motion must include those amendments.
- 6. Vote
 - a. Once the motion has been re-stated, all eligible voting members shall vote on the motion.
 - b. A simple majority (51%) affirmative vote is needed to pass the motion
 - c. If the motion deals with money, a three-fourths (75%) affirmative vote is needed
- 7. Other Important Information
 - a. A new motion cannot be made until the original motion dies or is voted on.
 - b. Motions can be TABLED, meaning that the motion can be set to be discussed at another time (such as the next meeting)
 - c. All motions, including who motioned, who seconded, any amendments, and the final vote, shall be documented in the meeting minutes. Additionally, the Sergeant at Arms shall keep a separate log of all motions passed.

Article II. Letters of Excuse

Section A. Absence from Chapter Event or Activity

When a member of ΣΩΝ is unable to attend a general meeting or planned activity, she is required to submit a typed letter, no later than 24 hours prior to the meeting or activity, to the Sergeant at Arms requesting her absence be excused.

In the event of an unforeseen or emergency situation that prevents a member from attending an event or activity, she must immediately notify the Sergeant at Arms via phone call, text message, or email notifying

her of the absence. The member shall be given the opportunity to submit a Letter of Excuse as soon possible after the emergency situation is resolved.

Any Letter of Excuse submitted will be read, discussed, and voted on at the General Meeting immediately following when the letter is received. A simple majority vote is required to pass a Letter and excuse the absence. If the letter is not passed, the member will be fined the appropriate amount for the missed meetings, activities, and/or deadlines.

Section B. Absence from National Event or Activity

If the elected National Board Representative is unable to attend a mandatory National event or activity, a Letter of Excuse must be submitted to the Chapter Sergeant at Arms and voted on by the Chapter's Active Membership, following the process outlined in Section A above. The Chapter will identify a replacement representative and shall immediately notify the NVP of Parliament of the name and contact information of the replacement representative.

If the Letter of Excuse from the elected Representative is passed by the Chapter, but a Representative is not present at the National event/activity, the Chapter shall be fined by the National Board for the missed event or activity. If no member of the Chapter is able to attend due to a mandatory Chapter event, the elected Representative may write a Letter of Excuse on behalf of the entire Chapter and submit to the NVP of Parliament.

See also the National Board Standing Rules for more information.

Article III. Binders

Every member of ΣΩΝ will need to purchase a black binder with a clear pocket in the front. The design of the binder shall be left at the discretion of the individual, however, the Greek letters ΣΩΝ must appear somewhere on the front of the binder. The member must also bring the binder to every meeting unless otherwise specified. It shall include bylaws, standing rules, agendas, minutes, and other pertinent information concerning the sorority. The binder should not be exposed to anyone other than the members of this sorority. The binder shall be well kept. If the binder is in any way damaged, it is up to the member to either buy a new binder or alter the current one. The binders are very important to the Sorority and are a representation of the individual and must therefore remain presentable.

At the last General Meeting of the month the Sergeant-at-Arms shall review all of the Active Members binders to ensure that they are well kept. If the Sergeant-at-Arms deems a binder unsatisfactory, the member shall have one week to improve or replace it, or be charged a missed deadline fine.

Article IV. Copy Card

A copy card should be provided by the Chapter for use by the Secretary. This copy card should only be used for copying any ΣΩΝ related paperwork as needed. The Secretary must keep an accurate log of all copying transactions and must be able to provide this log to the Executive Board when requested.

Article V. Meeting of the Minds

If any members feel at any point that a meeting of the mind is needed, she may contact the President, and the President MUST call all Active Membership to the meeting of the minds.

Attendance to the meeting of the minds is mandatory, but not limited to the Active Membership.

Article VI. Dues

It is collectively understood that organizations are founded around goals and principles, and that in order to achieve these goals an organization must have a strong financial foundation and the capacity to exist as an independent entity. The sorority of ΣΩΝ requires each member to have certain responsibilities. One of these responsibilities requires that members financially support the organization by paying dues. Each member should take into account that money received in the form of dues will be used for the betterment of the organization.

Payment Deadline

Dues must be paid in full as required by the Chapter Bylaws, Article XIII. Finances. Payment.

Contract

If a member realizes, in advance, that she will not be able to pay dues by the established deadline, she must request a payment plan from the Treasurer. The Treasurer shall supply her with a written contract stating her payment plan and payment due dates. She must, however, be paid in full by the fifth week of the quarter/semester. If a member misses a payment, she shall acquire a fine.

Failure to Pay

If a member is unable to pay dues by the established deadline, and neglects to make arrangements with the Treasurer, she shall receive a written warning. If after seven (7) days no attempt has been made by the member to explain her delinquencies or arrange payment, a one-time late charge of \$5 shall be imposed. The member will also be placed in Inactive Status.

Article VII. Fines

Every active member of ΣΩΝ is responsible for meeting any deadlines once those deadlines have been agreed upon. In the span of our involvement with ΣΩΝ, there will inevitably be instances where time is important and being punctual or turning things in by deadlines is crucial. Tardiness and missed deadlines are often a burden for the person responsible.

Fines are as follows:

Meetings

Unexcused absence- \$10 Arriving

Late or Leaving Early

- First five minutes - \$1

- Six to ten minutes - \$2
- Ten or more minutes - \$5

No Binder - \$5

Non-Professional Attire - \$5

Activities or Events Unexcused

absence - \$10 Arriving Late - \$5

Failure to submit a letter - \$5

Failure to explain delinquencies or arrange payment within seven days of missed activity/event - \$10

Payment of Dues

No payment and No Contract at first General Meeting – \$8 Missed

Payment - \$5

Late Charge - \$5

Checks

Bounced Check - \$25, or amount charged by the bank

Missed Deadlines

Any deadline - \$5

Article VIII. Mentorship Program

Section A. Purpose and Eligibility

The Chapter shall implement the Mentorship Program for any undergraduate Active or Inactive member whose academic performance falls below either of the following minimum standards or placed on academic probation by the University:

- A 2.3 quarter/semester GPA;
- A 2.5 cumulative GPA

Placement in the Mentorship Program is mandatory for the academic term immediately following the term in which the deficiency occurs. A member shall remain in the Mentorship Program until both minimum GPA requirements are satisfied.

Summer sessions are not monitored academic terms. If a member falls below the 2.3 quarter/semester GPA requirement at the conclusion of the Spring term, she shall be placed in the Mentorship Program for the Fall term, regardless of Summer enrollment or Summer term GPA.

If a member falls below the 2.5 cumulative GPA requirement at the conclusion of the Spring term, Summer coursework may be used to raise the cumulative GPA prior to the start of the Fall term. To qualify for removal from the Mentorship Program based on cumulative GPA, the member must provide the Chapter Vice President with updated grade documentation demonstrating that her cumulative GPA meets or exceeds 2.5. Summer term GPA may not be used to satisfy the 2.3 quarter/semester GPA requirement.

Section B. Member Requirements

Any member placed in the Mentorship Program must complete the following requirements:

1. Meet with her assigned Mentor and submit the following:
 - a. A copy of the previous quarter/semester grades
 - b. Current course schedule
 - c. A copy of each syllabus for the current academic term
2. Meet with her Mentor to establish a study plan by the end of the first month of the quarter/semester.
3. Dedicate a minimum of two (2) hours per week to academic improvement, in addition to required Library Hours. The following activities may count toward the required two hours:
 - a. Studying with the assigned Mentor
 - b. Attending professor office hours
 - c. Academic advising appointments
 - d. Tutoring sessions related to current coursework
4. The member must also:
 - a. Meet with her academic/major advisor by the end of the first month to determine an appropriate course schedule for the next academic term.
 - b. Meet with each current course professor on a biweekly basis, including at least once prior to final examinations.
 - c. Attend a study skills workshop through the Career Center, if available.
5. Submit a Progress Report to her Mentor every three (3) weeks.

Section C. Mentor Responsibilities

The assigned Mentor shall provide monthly progress updates to the Chapter Vice President regarding the member's academic standing and compliance with program requirements.

Article IX. Community Service

Section A. Requirement

One of the main goals of ΣΩΝ sorority is to help in the community. Each member of the organization must complete at least 10 hours of community service per quarter or 15 hours per semester and submit her ΣΩΝ Community Service Form to the Commissioner of Community Service. It is the responsibility of each individual to commit herself to whichever type of community service that ΣΩΝ agrees upon. Regardless of which community service project is chosen, she should commit herself to the required 30 hours per academic year. Of the required 30 hours: at minimum 10 hours must support the Chapter's designated Philanthropy; and at minimum 10 hours must raise awareness for and support survivors of sexual assault through an established organization (i.e., tabling, collaborating, volunteering, or advocacy). If the Chapter's Philanthropy aligns with supporting survivors of sexual assault, members may apply all 20 required hours toward the Chapter Philanthropy.

New Member Proration: For newly initiated members, the annual requirement will be prorated based on the number of full academic terms remaining in the academic year after initiation (10 hours per full quarter or 15 hours per full semester). If a member is initiated after the midpoint of a quarter or semester, community service

hours for that term are not required, and the requirement will begin the following full academic term. Prorated members must still complete proportional philanthropy and survivor support hours within their adjusted total requirement.

The following do not count towards service hours: class requirements, political campaigning, unpaid work for a business, babysitting, charitable donations, or paid service. Tabling and transportation of donated items do count as service hours.

Section B. Makeup Project

The Commissioner of Community Service is responsible for keeping track of the community hours completed by each member. If a member does not meet the minimum required hours by the end of the Fall term, the remaining hours must roll over and must be completed by the end of the Winter or Spring term within the same academic year. No formal make-up projects are required for Fall deficiencies unless the member remains deficient at the end of the academic year. If a member fails to complete the full annual service requirement by the conclusion of the Spring term, they must be placed on Community Service Make-Up status for the following academic term.

The member must complete a make-up project that directly benefits the Chapter. The project must be approved by the Commissioner of Community Service prior to implementation, have a clearly defined scope and deadline, and be completed by the end of the following quarter or semester. The make-up project does not replace the member's ongoing service requirement for the new academic term. If the make-up project is not completed by the deadline, the member must complete an additional 10 study hours by the end of the following quarter/semester.

Article X. Fundraising Credits

Any member who surpasses their share of the required minimum during any fundraiser should be rewarded for their extra effort. Giving members credit on their individual ΣΩΝ account is a way to not only help encourage members to raise more than just the minimum, but also to reward those members who help in raising the extra funds for our organization.

Members who exceed the agreed upon minimum amount to be raised during any fundraising efforts should receive a credit of 40% of the excess amount towards their ΣΩΝ account. For example, a particular fundraising event required each member to raise \$25. Member X raised \$125, which is \$100 more than the required amount. Member X will be given a credit of 40% of \$100, or \$40, toward her Chapter account.

This credited amount, however, can only be used to pay off individual dues, fines, or any other expenses incurred by activities/functions dealing with or pertaining to ΣΩΝ. This credit should not be converted into personal funds for the individual.

Article XI. Advisor Oath

The Advisor shall undertake an oath. For the Oath to be read, all Active members must be present and dressed

in professional attire. They must stand behind the Advisor with their hands behind their backs.

The President shall face the Advisor and read the oath, which will be as follows:

“On this day <state the date>,
We the sisters of Sigma Omega Nu recognize <state Advisor’s name>
As an Advisor of Sigma Omega Nu <Chapter> Chapter at the <University Name>.
For the <state the academic year> academic school year.

Do you, <state advisors name>, accept?
<Advisor answers yes>

Do you agree to abide by all University Advisor guidelines?
<Advisor answers yes>

Do you agree to abide by the sections of the Bylaws that pertain to advisors as these were outlined and
addressed to you during your advisor workshop?
< Advisor answers yes >

On behalf of the sisters of Sigma Omega Nu, I would like to congratulate you
For becoming an Advisor of Sigma Omega Nu <Chapter> Chapter at <University Name >
For the <state the year ex: 2002-03> academic year.”

Article XII. Amendments

In order to run meetings more efficiently, the proposed Standing Rules shall only be reviewed if 3/4 of the active membership has voted to consider the rule. Any rule that does not receive a 3/4 vote shall not be discussed and may be resubmitted for consideration at a later date. Once a 3/4 vote has been obtained on a proposed standing rule, then only a simple majority vote will be needed in order to pass the rule.

Following approval by the Chapter, the new rule must be submitted to the National Board for final approval.

Article XIII. Proposals

Section A. Chapter Procedure

Should any Active member of the Chapter wish to propose a change to any of the governing documents of Sigma Omega Nu, the following procedure must be followed.

1. The proposal must be submitted on Official Sigma Omega Nu Letterhead. The proposal must include reasoning or justification for the proposed change.
2. The proposer will write the proposed changes in the same format as the document in which she wishes to see the changes. This includes the article, section and subsection (as appropriate). The proposal must clearly identify which portions of the document are being changed, either through tracked changes, different font color, or highlighted text.
3. The proposal must be discussed and voted on by the Active membership at a Chapter General Meeting. The proposal must receive an affirmative 3/4ths vote before being submitted to National Board.

4. The Chapter Representative must submit the proposal to the National Vice President and NVP of Communications no later than 21 days prior to the next National Council meeting. A copy of the Chapter meeting minutes where the proposal was discussed and voted on must also be provided.
5. The proposal will then follow the procedure outlined in the National Standing Rules, Article I. If the proposal is passed, it will be incorporated into the appropriate document(s). If the proposal is not passed, the Chapter may revise based on feedback received during the National Council meeting and may resubmit the proposal in the future.

Proposals written by Alumnae may be submitted directly to the National Vice President and NVP of Communications, but it is at the discretion of the Executive Cabinet if the proposal will be accepted for consideration.

Section B. Ineligibility

Proposals that do not meet the above guidelines in any way are subject to the following:

1. Proposals submitted by any Chapter member or officer other than the elected National Board Representative will not be considered.
2. Proposals submitted to any Officer, Representative or Chapter, other than those officers specified above, will not be considered.
3. Proposals written as opinion and not in the format of the document under review will not be considered.
4. Proposals submitted with less than 21 days until the next National Council meeting will not be considered until the following meeting.
5. Proposals submitted by Inactive Sisters, Little Sisters, or Advisors will not be considered.